

# The 15-Minute Backyard Audit: Find Your Garden's Hidden Growing Space

A free printable checklist that walks you through your own backyard to spot unused space, sun exposure, and layout fixes — so you know exactly where to start before you plant a single seed.

## Why Small Space Doesn't Mean Small Results

Most people think self-sufficiency requires acreage. In reality, smart layout, vertical growing, and the right crop choices can turn even a modest backyard into a steady source of vegetables, herbs, and pantry staples — often producing more per square foot than a sprawling, poorly planned garden.

## The Mistakes That Keep Backyard Gardens Small

Overcrowded beds, poor soil prep, and planting the wrong vegetables for your space are the top reasons backyard gardens underperform. Fixing even two or three of these mistakes can dramatically increase what you're able to grow and preserve.

## A Realistic Path to Self-Sufficiency

Real self-sufficiency isn't about doing everything at once — it's about layering skills over time: food growing, preserving, water catchment, and small-scale animal keeping where local rules allow. Starting with the backyard garden is the foundation everything else builds on.